

Groups on Russia Preliminary Report

Rafael Campos-Gottardo & Alan Nemirovski

2026-01-31

Method 1: Group-Based Indices

Creating Group-Based Indices

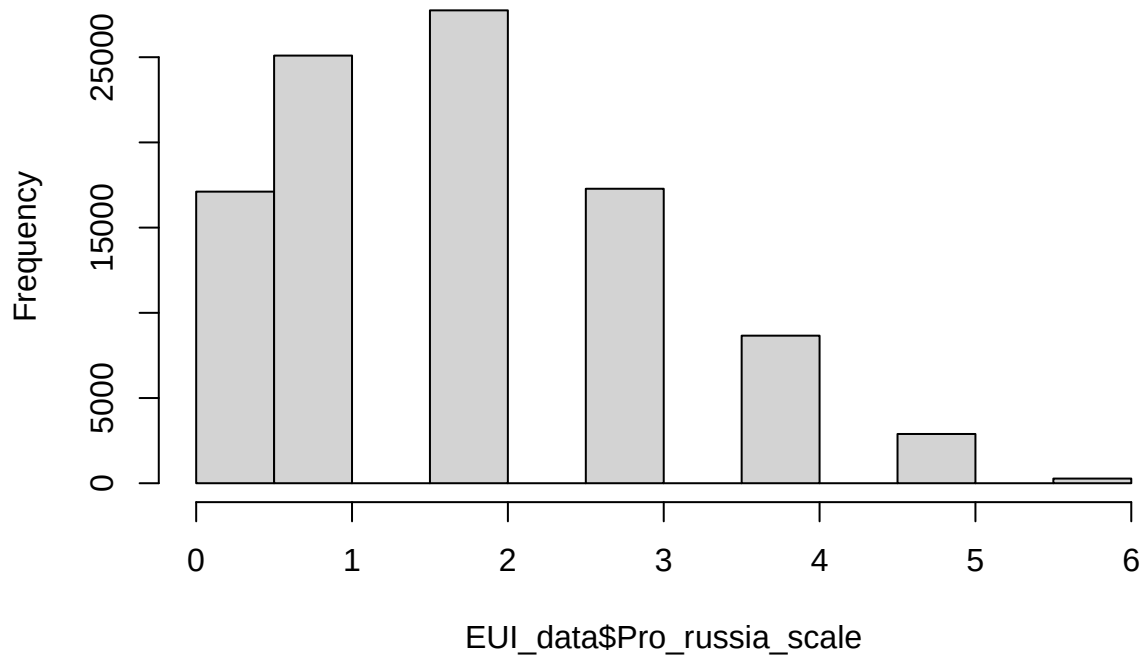
Pro Russian Long Term

0 - 6 scale

Respondents gain 1 point if: - They do not think Russia is their countries greatest threat (Q68). - They think that Europeans should pursue trade and diplomacy with Russia (Q73). - They think their country spends too much on defence (Q69) - They do not support democracy ($Q5 < 5/10$) - They do not trust the European Union (New_Q43)

```
hist(EUI_data$Pro_russia_scale)
```

Histogram of EUI_data\$Pro_russia_scale



Pro Russian Short Term

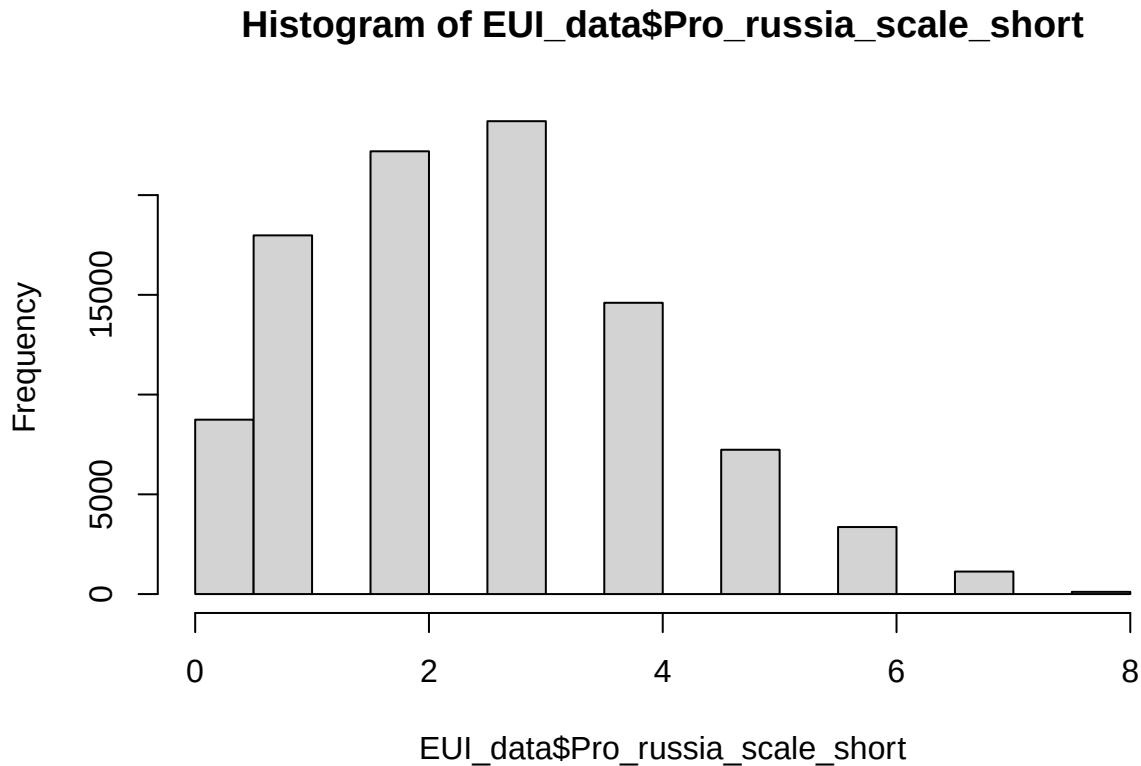
0 - 7 scale

- Respondents gain 1 point if:
 - They do not think Russia is their countries greatest threat (Q68).

- They think that Europeans should pursue trade and diplomacy with Russia (Q73).
- They think their country spends too much on defence (Q69)
- They do not support democracy (Q5 < 5/10)
- They do not trust the European Union (New_Q43)
- They do want Russia to gain territory in Ukraine (EUI_Ukraine_Outcome)
- They do not support Aid to Ukraine (New_Q78, less than 4 on a 0-9 scale)

Question: Q5 only captures ideological pro Russia not situational.

```
hist(EUI_data$Pro_russia_scale_short)
```

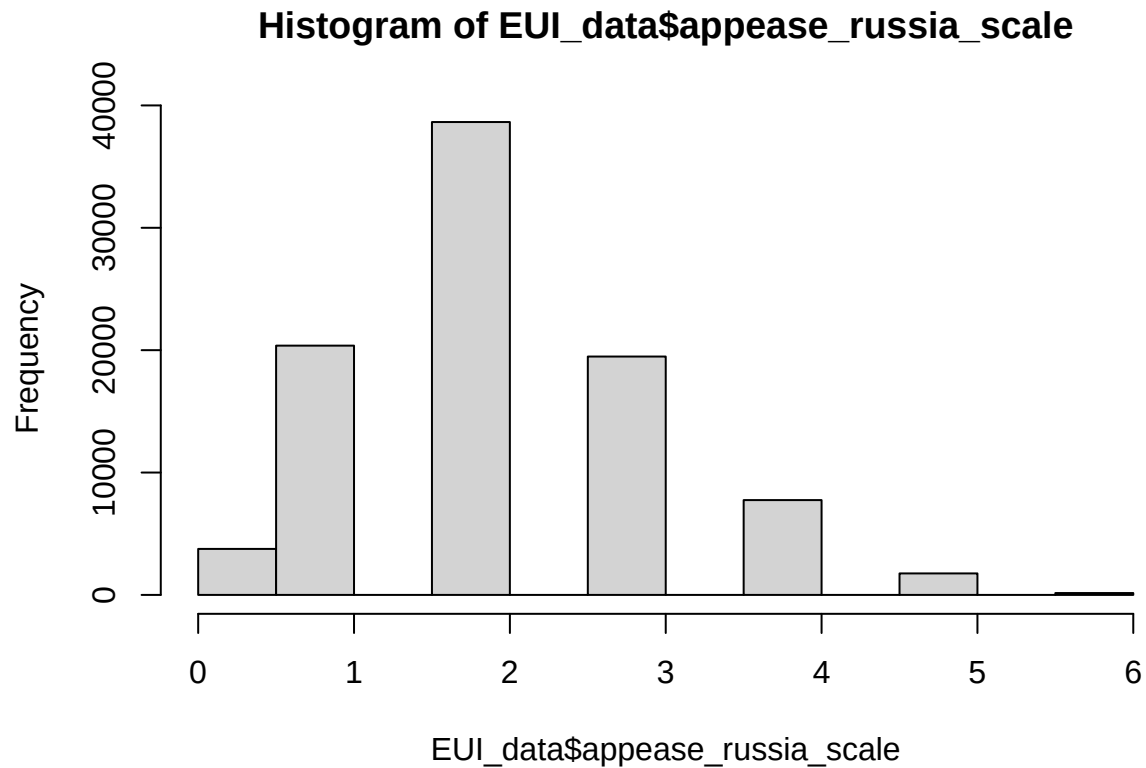


Russian Appeaser Long Term

0 - 6 scale

- Respondents gain 1 point if:
 - they think Russia is their country's greatest threat (Q68) or they think Nuclear proliferation is their greatest threat.
 - They want to trade with Russia (instead of invest in defence) (Q73)
 - They think their country spends too much on defence (Q69)
 - They oppose the creation of an integrated European army (Q70)
 - They think that NATO is not important for their country's defence (Q71)
 - They would vote to remain in the EU (Q9)

```
hist(EUI_data$appease_russia_scale)
```



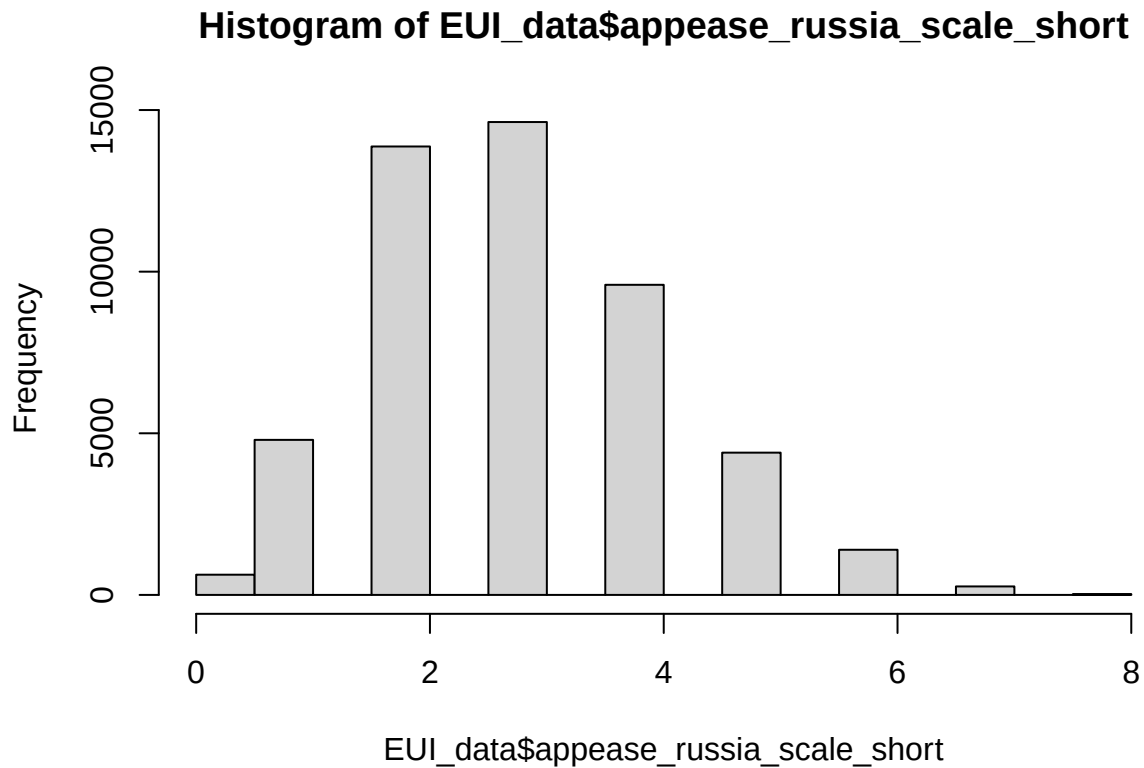
Russian Appeaser Short Term

Only post 2023

0 - 8 scale

Respondents gain 1 point if: - They do not think Russia is their country's greatest threat (Q68) - They want to trade with Russia (instead of invest in defence) (Q73) - Their country spends too much on defence (Q69) - They oppose the creation of an integrated European army (Q70) - They think that NATO is not important for their country's defence (Q71) - They would vote to remain in the EU (Q9) - Favour a return to the territorial situation before the war (EUI_Ukraine_Outcome) - Support only compromises to end the war (New_Q78_variables)

```
hist(EUI_data$appease_russia_scale_short)
```



Testing Method 1 Variables

Correlations

First, I check the correlation of the pro-Russia and appease Russia scales to ensure they are capturing different concepts.

The long term scales

```
cor(EUI_data$Pro_russia_scale, EUI_data$appease_russia_scale, use = "complete.obs")
```

```
## [1] 0.2822461
```

The short term scales

```
cor(EUI_data$Pro_russia_scale_short, EUI_data$appease_russia_scale_short,
    use = "complete.obs")
```

```
## [1] 0.3421119
```

Both scales are weakly correlated at $r = 0.27$ and $r = 0.35$ respectively. Indicating that the scales are not highly collinear.

Method 2: Combined index

Generating combined index

Long term appeaser-supporter scale

0 - 7 scale

Respondents get 1 point if:

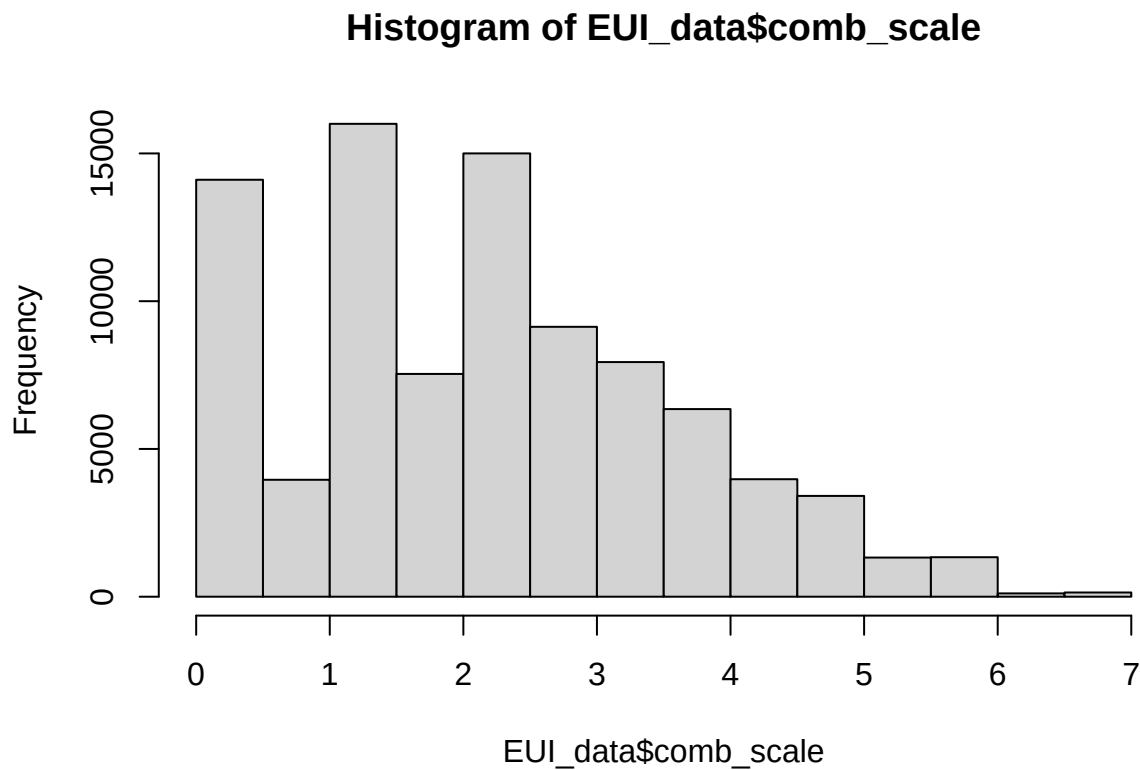
- They do not think Russia or nuclear non-proliferation is their countries greatest threat (Q68).

- They think that Europeans should pursue trade and diplomacy with Russia (Q73).
- They think their country spends too much on defence (Q69)
- They do not support democracy ($Q5 < 5/10$)
- They do not trust the European Union (New_Q43)

Respondents get 0.5 points if:

- Do not support an integrated European army (Q70).
- They do not think NATO is important to their country's defence (Q71).
- They would vote to remain in the EU (Q9)

```
hist(EUI_data$comb_scale)
```



Short term appeaser-supporter scale 0 - 9.5 scale

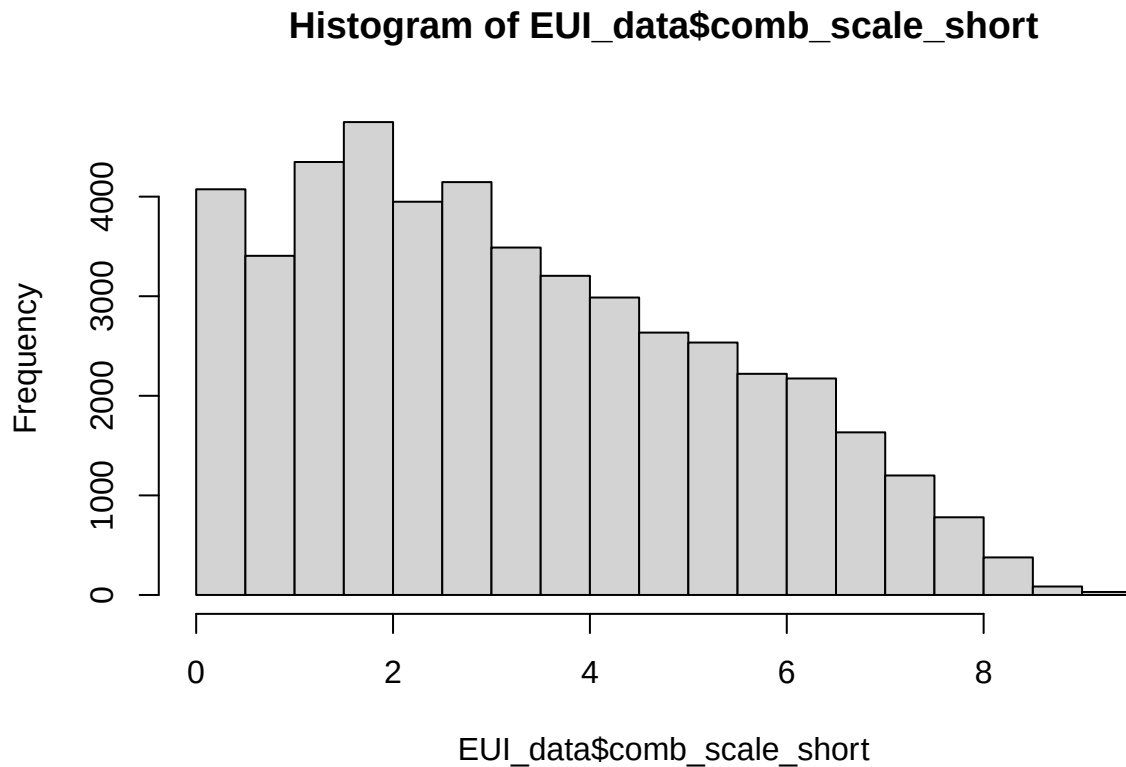
Respondents get 1 point if:

- They do not think Russia is their countries greatest threat (Q68).
- They think that Europeans should pursue trade and diplomacy with Russia (Q73).
- They think their country spends too much on defence (Q69)
- They do not support democracy ($Q5 < 5/10$)
- They do not trust the European Union (New_Q43)

Respondents get 0.5 points if:

- Do not support an integrated European army (Q70).
- They do not think NATO is important to their country's defence (Q71).
- They would vote to remain in the EU (Q9)
- They support a return to the pre 2022 status quo in Ukraine (EUI_Ukraine_Outcome).
- Support only compromises to end the war (New_Q78_variables)

```
hist(EUI_data$comb_scale_short)
```



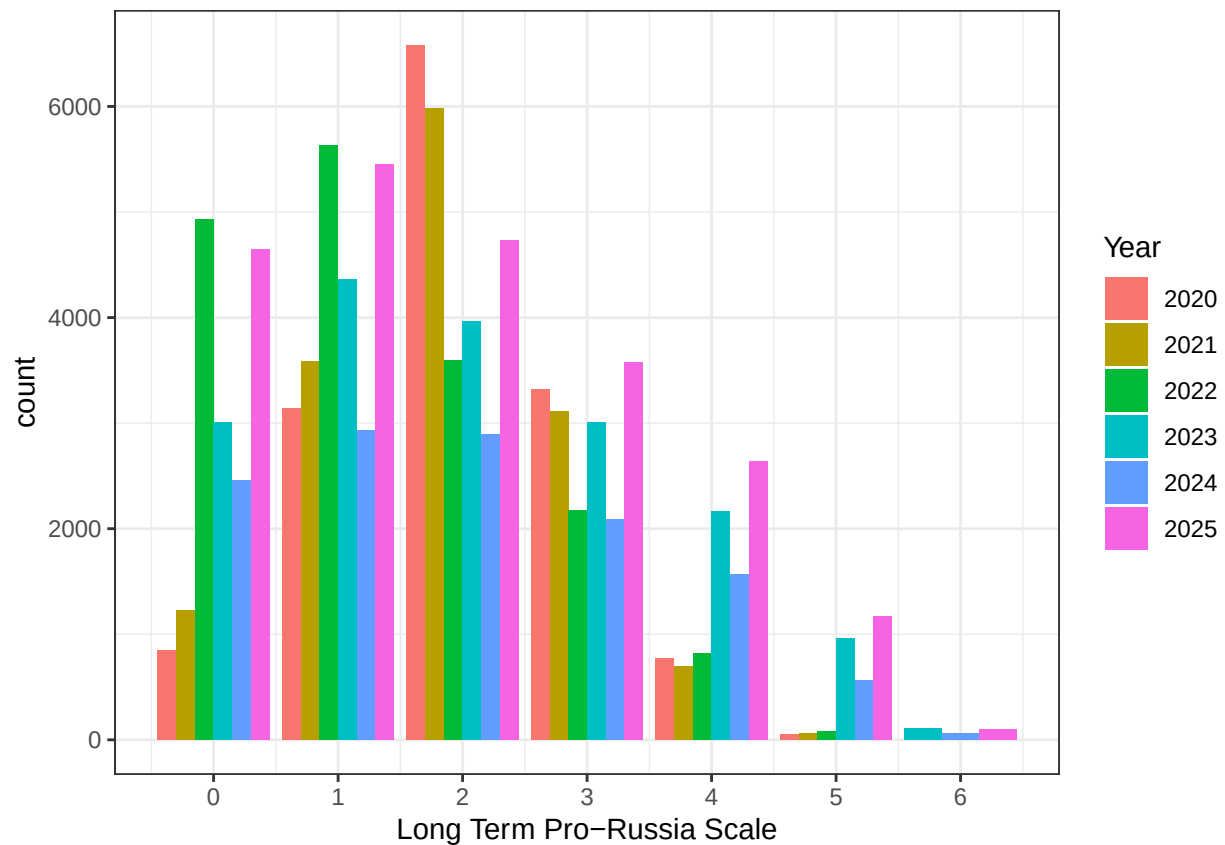
Comparisons of measures

Over time distributions

Long term pro-Russia

```
EUI_data %>%  
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%  
  ggplot(aes(x = Pro_russia_scale, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +  
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +  
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Long Term Pro-Russia Scale") +  
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:6) +  
  theme_bw()
```

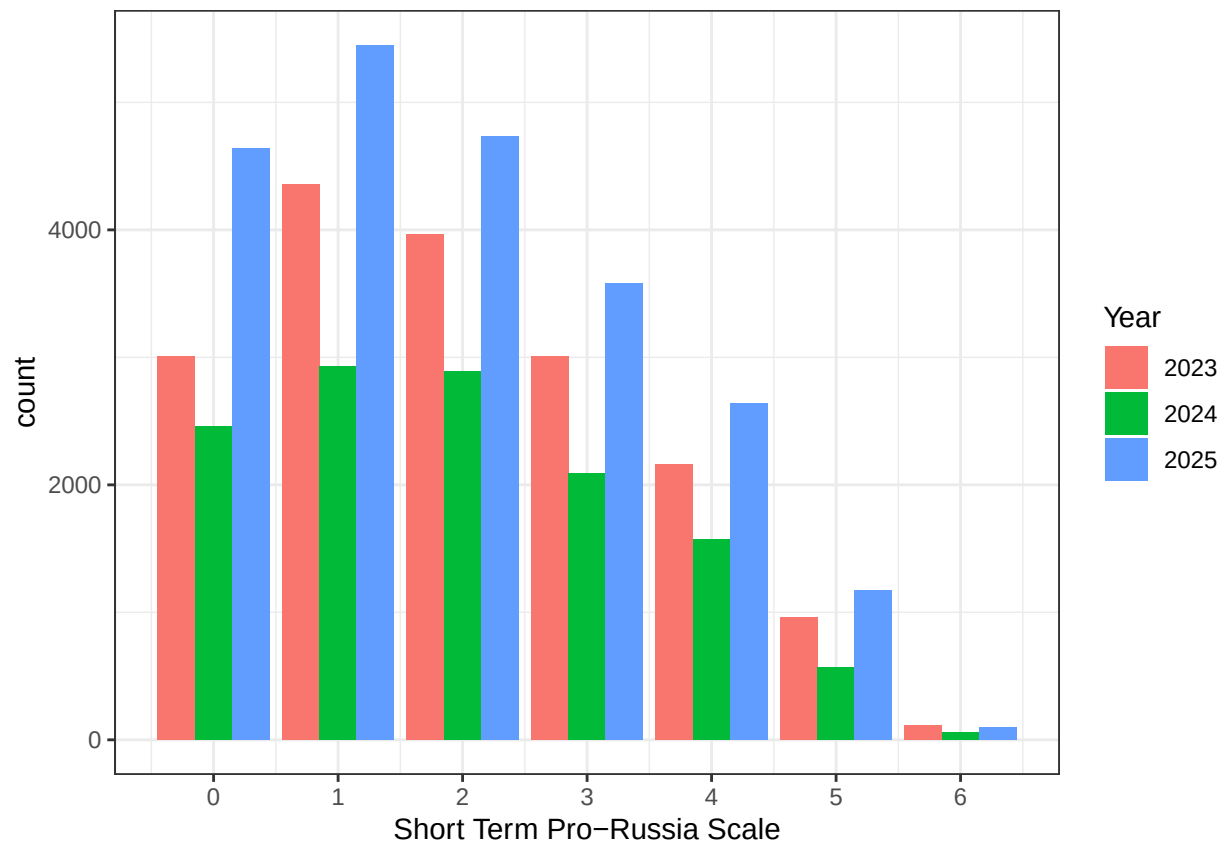
```
## Warning: Removed 40925 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range  
## (`stat_count()`).
```



Short term pro-Russia

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = Pro_russia_scale, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Short Term Pro-Russia Scale") +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:7) +
  theme_bw()
```

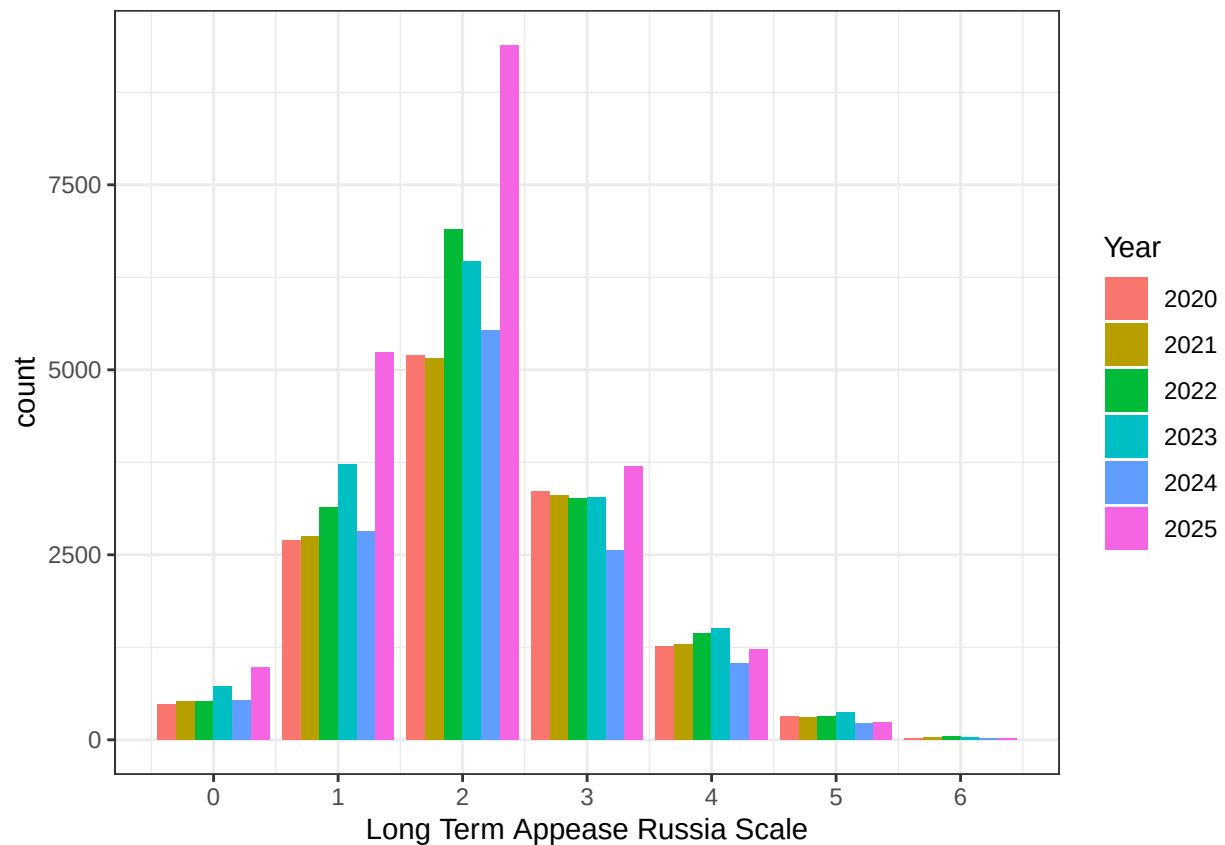
```
## Warning: Removed 21027 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
## (`stat_count()`).
```



Long term Appease Russia

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = appease_russia_scale, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:6) +
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Long Term Appease Russia Scale") +
  theme_bw()
```

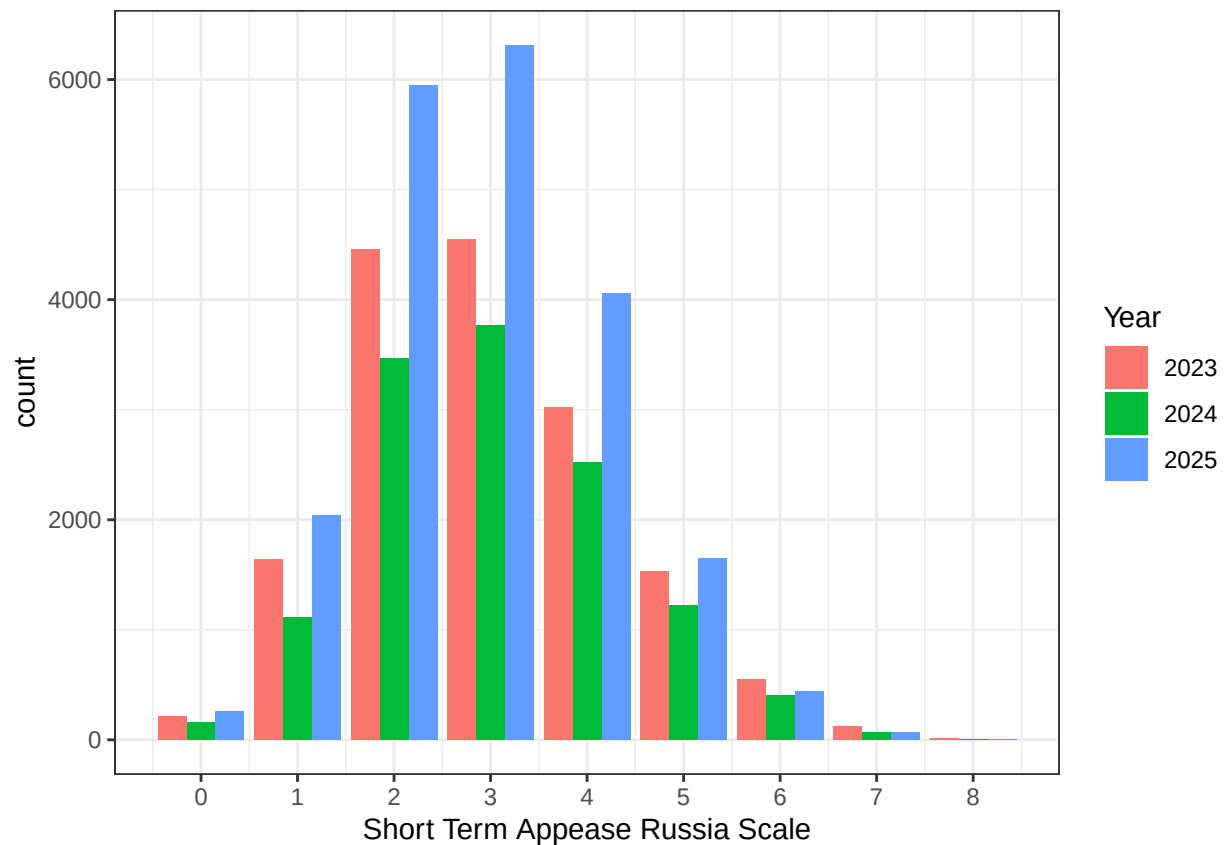
```
## Warning: Removed 48082 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
## (`stat_count()`).
```

Short term Appease Russia

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = appease_russia_scale_short, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:8) +
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Short Term Appease Russia Scale") +
  theme_bw()
```

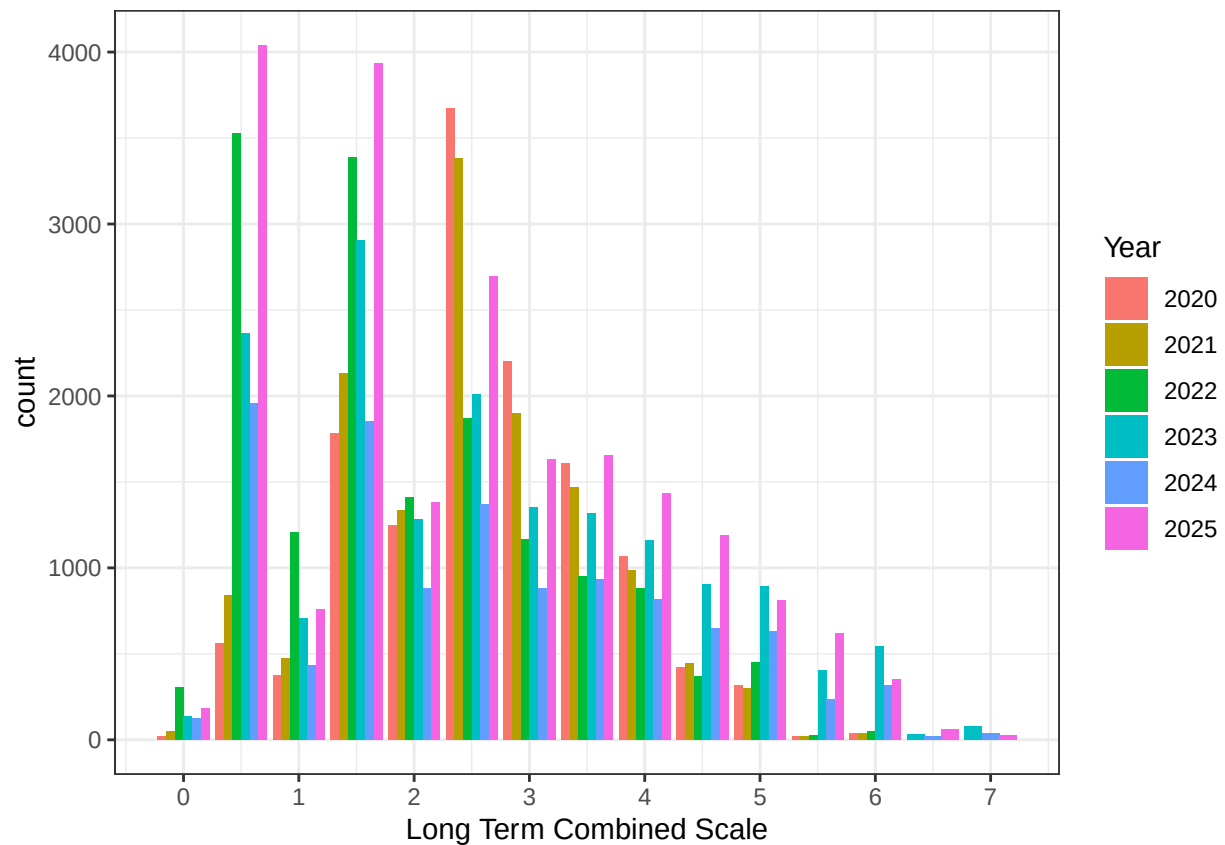
```
## Warning: Removed 90391 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
## (`stat_count()`).
```



Long term Combined Scale

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = comb_scale, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:8) +
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Long Term Combined Scale") +
  theme_bw()
```

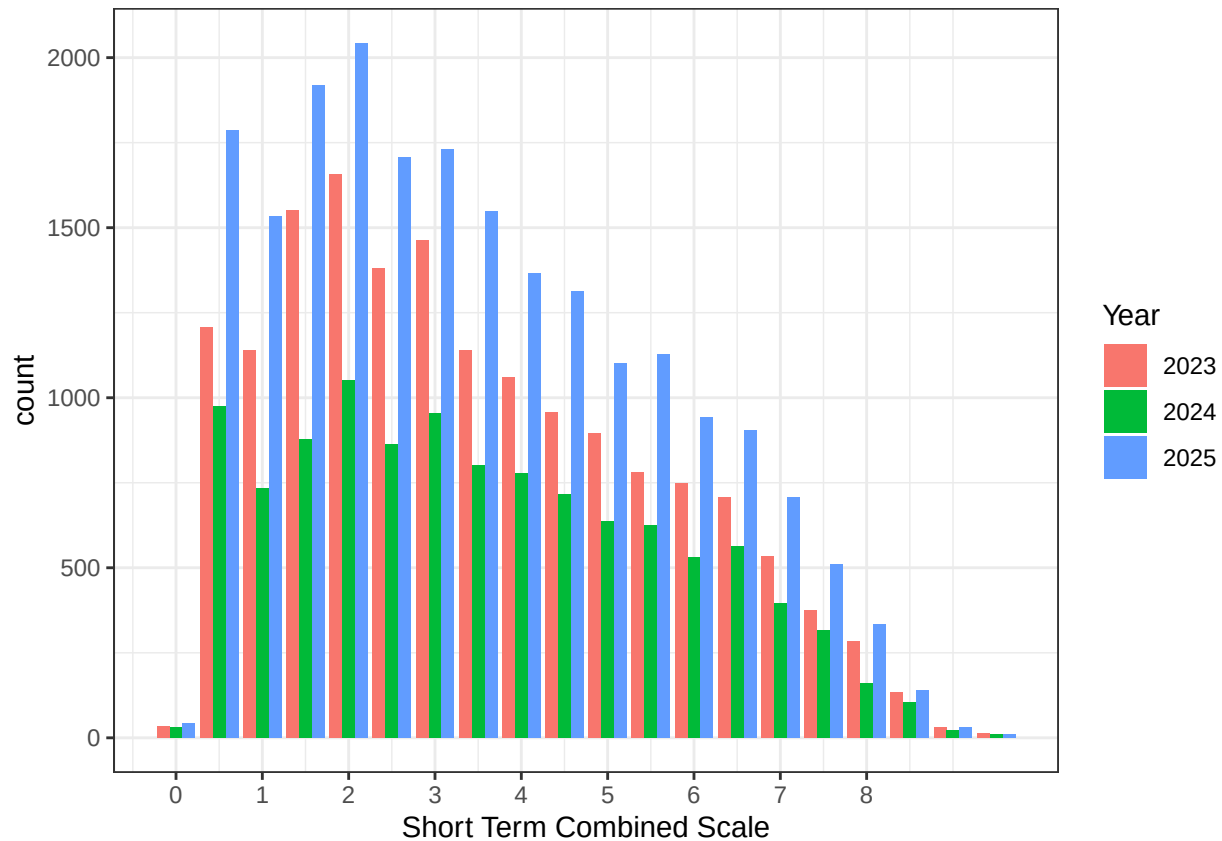
```
## Warning: Removed 49659 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
## (`stat_count()`).
```



Short term Combined Scale

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  ggplot(aes(x = comb_scale_short, fill = as.factor(Year), group = as.factor(Year))) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = 0:8) +
  labs(fill = "Year", x = "Short Term Combined Scale") +
  theme_bw()
```

```
## Warning: Removed 91968 rows containing non-finite outside the scale range
## (`stat_count()`).
```



Average Measures (ALL) by Country

Long Term

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  group_by(country) %>%
  summarise(`Pro-Russian Scale` = mean(Pro_russia_scale, na.rm = TRUE),
            `Appease Russia Scale` = mean(appease_russia_scale, na.rm = TRUE),
            `Combined Scale` = mean(comb_scale, na.rm = TRUE)) %>%
  arrange(-`Pro-Russian Scale`) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

country	Pro-Russian Scale	Appease Russia Scale	Combined Scale
Bulgaria	2.75	2.39	3.34
Greece	2.64	2.66	3.27
Italy	2.47	2.27	3.01
Slovakia	2.33	2.46	2.90
Croatia	2.32	2.14	2.85
Austria	2.28	2.23	2.84
Czech Republic	2.12	2.17	2.58
France	2.05	1.89	2.58
Spain	2.00	2.19	2.58
Hungary	1.98	2.31	2.55
Belgium	1.97	1.76	2.41
Germany	1.96	2.12	2.50
Romania	1.93	2.29	2.46

country	Pro-Russian Scale	Appease Russia Scale	Combined Scale
Ireland	1.73	1.87	2.28
Netherlands	1.68	1.77	2.15
Portugal	1.67	1.59	2.12
Sweden	1.55	1.97	2.08
UK	1.44	NaN	NaN
Denmark	1.41	2.01	1.96
Finland	1.33	2.15	1.87
Poland	1.33	2.04	1.86
Lithuania	1.27	2.37	1.82

Short Term

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  group_by(country) %>%
  summarise(`Pro-Russian Scale` = mean(Pro_russia_scale_short, na.rm = TRUE),
            `Appease Russia Scale` = mean(appease_russia_scale_short, na.rm = TRUE),
            `Combined Scale` = mean(comb_scale_short, na.rm = TRUE)) %>%
  arrange(-`Pro-Russian Scale`) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

country	Pro-Russian Scale	Appease Russia Scale	Combined Scale
Bulgaria	3.78	3.27	4.90
Greece	3.54	3.75	4.91
Italy	3.35	3.36	4.56
Slovakia	3.25	3.33	4.29
Austria	3.08	3.35	4.21
Croatia	2.91	3.07	3.93
Hungary	2.91	3.37	4.11
Czech Republic	2.89	3.13	3.84
France	2.83	2.78	3.78
Romania	2.80	3.23	3.89
Germany	2.79	3.02	3.65
Spain	2.69	3.00	3.42
Belgium	2.53	2.76	3.47
Netherlands	2.37	2.55	2.97
Ireland	2.23	2.72	3.20
Sweden	2.18	2.55	2.62
Poland	2.09	2.72	2.82
UK	2.08	NaN	NaN
Denmark	2.06	2.74	2.46
Portugal	2.03	2.50	2.94
Lithuania	1.95	2.84	2.38
Finland	1.92	2.59	2.21

Create group variables

(Using Pro-Russia + Russia Appeaser scales:) Those who score 3 or less on both scales are considered pro-Europeans, those who score 4 or above on the Russian appeaser scale are considered Russian appeasers and those that score 4 or above on the Pro Russia scale are considered Pro-Russian.

```
EUI_data <- EUI_data %>%
  mutate(Russia_groups_long = case_when(appease_russia_scale < 4 & Pro_russia_scale < 4 ~ "Anti-Russia",
    appease_russia_scale > 3 ~ "Russia Appeaser",
    Pro_russia_scale > 3 ~ "Pro Russian"),
  Russia_groups_short = case_when(appease_russia_scale_short < 4 & Pro_russia_scale_short < 4 ~
    appease_russia_scale_short > 3 ~ "Russia Appeaser",
    Pro_russia_scale_short > 3 ~ "Pro Russian")
  )
```

Note: A similar grouping measure could be reconstructed with thresholds set on the combined index.

Groups over time

Long Term Variable

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  group_by(Year, Russia_groups_long) %>%
  summarise(n = n(), .groups = "drop_last") %>%
  filter(!is.na(Russia_groups_long)) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) * 100) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

Year	Russia_groups_long	n	Percentage
2020	Anti-Russia	11241	84.30
2020	Pro Russian	502	3.76
2020	Russia Appeaser	1592	11.94
2021	Anti-Russia	11294	84.51
2021	Pro Russian	444	3.32
2021	Russia Appeaser	1626	12.17
2022	Anti-Russia	13413	85.86
2022	Pro Russian	420	2.69
2022	Russia Appeaser	1789	11.45
2023	Anti-Russia	12019	74.49
2023	Pro Russian	2211	13.70
2023	Russia Appeaser	1906	11.81
2024	Anti-Russia	8467	74.62
2024	Pro Russian	1613	14.22
2024	Russia Appeaser	1267	11.17
2025	Anti-Russia	16290	78.22
2025	Pro Russian	3057	14.68
2025	Russia Appeaser	1479	7.10

Short Term Variable

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  group_by(Year, Russia_groups_short) %>%
  summarise(n = n(), .groups = "drop_last") %>%
  filter(!is.na(Russia_groups_short)) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) * 100) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

Year	Russia_groups_short	n	Percentage
2023	Anti-Russia	8731	53.82
2023	Pro Russian	2257	13.91
2023	Russia Appeaser	5236	32.27
2024	Anti-Russia	5817	49.08
2024	Pro Russian	1821	15.36
2024	Russia Appeaser	4215	35.56
2025	Anti-Russia	11289	53.82
2025	Pro Russian	3458	16.49
2025	Russia Appeaser	6227	29.69

Groups by Country

Long Term Measure

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2019) %>%
  group_by(country, Russia_groups_long) %>%
  summarise(n = n(), .groups = "drop_last") %>%
  filter(!is.na(Russia_groups_long)) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) * 100) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

country	Russia_groups_long	n	Percentage
Austria	Anti-Russia	537	71.03
Austria	Pro Russian	136	17.99
Austria	Russia Appeaser	83	10.98
Belgium	Anti-Russia	1211	83.17
Belgium	Pro Russian	179	12.29
Belgium	Russia Appeaser	66	4.53
Bulgaria	Anti-Russia	1501	58.18
Bulgaria	Pro Russian	769	29.81
Bulgaria	Russia Appeaser	310	12.02
Croatia	Anti-Russia	1801	72.65
Croatia	Pro Russian	385	15.53
Croatia	Russia Appeaser	293	11.82
Czech Republic	Anti-Russia	578	70.83
Czech Republic	Pro Russian	164	20.10
Czech Republic	Russia Appeaser	74	9.07
Denmark	Anti-Russia	6892	89.63
Denmark	Pro Russian	264	3.43
Denmark	Russia Appeaser	533	6.93
Finland	Anti-Russia	3932	87.32
Finland	Pro Russian	160	3.55
Finland	Russia Appeaser	411	9.13
France	Anti-Russia	6217	82.82
France	Pro Russian	789	10.51
France	Russia Appeaser	501	6.67
Germany	Anti-Russia	6205	78.72
Germany	Pro Russian	649	8.23
Germany	Russia Appeaser	1028	13.04
Greece	Anti-Russia	2925	65.01
Greece	Pro Russian	600	13.34

country	Russia_groups_long	n	Percentage
Greece	Russia Appeaser	974	21.65
Hungary	Anti-Russia	3181	79.17
Hungary	Pro Russian	419	10.43
Hungary	Russia Appeaser	418	10.40
Ireland	Anti-Russia	639	88.63
Ireland	Pro Russian	57	7.91
Ireland	Russia Appeaser	25	3.47
Italy	Anti-Russia	5203	71.06
Italy	Pro Russian	984	13.44
Italy	Russia Appeaser	1135	15.50
Lithuania	Anti-Russia	3944	82.03
Lithuania	Pro Russian	249	5.18
Lithuania	Russia Appeaser	615	12.79
Netherlands	Anti-Russia	3978	89.43
Netherlands	Pro Russian	232	5.22
Netherlands	Russia Appeaser	238	5.35
Poland	Anti-Russia	4450	89.45
Poland	Pro Russian	219	4.40
Poland	Russia Appeaser	306	6.15
Portugal	Anti-Russia	742	89.94
Portugal	Pro Russian	63	7.64
Portugal	Russia Appeaser	20	2.42
Romania	Anti-Russia	3611	80.39
Romania	Pro Russian	369	8.21
Romania	Russia Appeaser	512	11.40
Slovakia	Anti-Russia	1642	62.41
Slovakia	Pro Russian	573	21.78
Slovakia	Russia Appeaser	416	15.81
Spain	Anti-Russia	6598	81.11
Spain	Pro Russian	493	6.06
Spain	Russia Appeaser	1044	12.83
Sweden	Anti-Russia	6937	87.25
Sweden	Pro Russian	357	4.49
Sweden	Russia Appeaser	657	8.26
UK	Pro Russian	137	100.00

Short Term Measure

```
EUI_data %>%
  filter(Year > 2022) %>%
  group_by(country, Russia_groups_short) %>%
  summarise(n = n(), .groups = "drop_last") %>%
  filter(!is.na(Russia_groups_short)) %>%
  mutate(Percentage = n / sum(n) * 100) %>%
  kable(digits = 2)
```

country	Russia_groups_short	n	Percentage
Austria	Anti-Russia	287	37.71
Austria	Pro Russian	130	17.08
Austria	Russia Appeaser	344	45.20
Belgium	Anti-Russia	828	56.79

country	Russia_groups_short	n	Percentage
Belgium	Pro Russian	271	18.59
Belgium	Russia Appeaser	359	24.62
Bulgaria	Anti-Russia	536	24.43
Bulgaria	Pro Russian	730	33.27
Bulgaria	Russia Appeaser	928	42.30
Croatia	Anti-Russia	1021	48.07
Croatia	Pro Russian	356	16.76
Croatia	Russia Appeaser	747	35.17
Czech Republic	Anti-Russia	382	46.76
Czech Republic	Pro Russian	154	18.85
Czech Republic	Russia Appeaser	281	34.39
Denmark	Anti-Russia	2635	70.51
Denmark	Pro Russian	212	5.67
Denmark	Russia Appeaser	890	23.82
Finland	Anti-Russia	1715	76.15
Finland	Pro Russian	113	5.02
Finland	Russia Appeaser	424	18.83
France	Anti-Russia	1916	53.53
France	Pro Russian	712	19.89
France	Russia Appeaser	951	26.57
Germany	Anti-Russia	1615	43.37
Germany	Pro Russian	507	13.61
Germany	Russia Appeaser	1602	43.02
Greece	Anti-Russia	456	23.42
Greece	Pro Russian	376	19.31
Greece	Russia Appeaser	1115	57.27
Hungary	Anti-Russia	639	32.37
Hungary	Pro Russian	482	24.42
Hungary	Russia Appeaser	853	43.21
Ireland	Anti-Russia	448	62.05
Ireland	Pro Russian	86	11.91
Ireland	Russia Appeaser	188	26.04
Italy	Anti-Russia	1190	35.68
Italy	Pro Russian	653	19.58
Italy	Russia Appeaser	1492	44.74
Lithuania	Anti-Russia	1641	71.19
Lithuania	Pro Russian	147	6.38
Lithuania	Russia Appeaser	517	22.43
Netherlands	Anti-Russia	1564	68.24
Netherlands	Pro Russian	261	11.39
Netherlands	Russia Appeaser	467	20.38
Poland	Anti-Russia	1766	68.21
Poland	Pro Russian	299	11.55
Poland	Russia Appeaser	524	20.24
Portugal	Anti-Russia	576	69.73
Portugal	Pro Russian	95	11.50
Portugal	Russia Appeaser	155	18.77
Romania	Anti-Russia	914	42.02
Romania	Pro Russian	394	18.11
Romania	Russia Appeaser	867	39.86
Slovakia	Anti-Russia	782	35.10
Slovakia	Pro Russian	491	22.04

country	Russia_groups_short	n	Percentage
Slovakia	Russia Appeaser	955	42.86
Spain	Anti-Russia	2112	57.20
Spain	Pro Russian	361	9.78
Spain	Russia Appeaser	1219	33.02
Sweden	Anti-Russia	2814	73.00
Sweden	Pro Russian	241	6.25
Sweden	Russia Appeaser	800	20.75
UK	Pro Russian	465	100.00

Next steps

- Decide which measure to use for the groups.
- Decide what social medias we want to scrape to identify discourse surrounding the war in Ukraine.
 - We need API access for Meta.
 - We can then use BERTopic to identify themes in this corpus.